Your AI cheat sheet for work

Ten words decoded, a prompt that works, and where to learn next.

Five words, in plain English

Prompt

The words you type to tell the AI what you want.

Context

Everything it can see while it answers: your words, your files, the chat so far.

Hallucination

A confident answer that is wrong. Check every name, number and date yourself.

Licence

The paid seat that gives one person the work version of a tool.

Data rules

What your organisation lets you put into the tool. Ask before you paste anything in.

Five more, for when systems connect

Integration

Two systems passing information to each other, so nobody retypes it.

API

The door a system opens so other software can read from it or write to it.

Trigger

The event that starts an automation, like a new order email arriving.

Agent

AI that takes steps on its own, rather than only answering you.

Human in the loop

A named person approves before anything pays money or reaches a customer.

A prompt that works has five parts

Task

What you want, in one sentence.

Context

Who it is for and why it matters.

Material

Attach the file. Do not describe it.

Format

“A table with three columns” beats “summarise”.

The unsure rule

“If it is not in the file, write not stated.” This cuts down on made-up answers.

The same request, with all five

Before

“Summarise this contract.”

After

“List the payment terms, notice period and renewal date from the attached contract as a table. Quote the clause number for each. If one is not in the contract, write not stated.”

Where to learn, from the makers

AI Fluency for Small Business

Free online course from Anthropic, the maker of Claude. On Anthropic Academy.

Claude 101

The basics of Claude, on the same Anthropic Academy site.

Copilot learning hub

Microsoft's own training paths and videos for Microsoft 365 Copilot, on Microsoft Learn.

OpenAI Academy

OpenAI's guides and courses, including Apply AI at Work and Lead AI Adoption.

One of these a week.

Something you can use before Friday.

More prompts like slide 5, free:
aiforcompanies.co.uk/prompts
This is not legal advice.
Save for Friday